network-centric warfare architectures, allowing real-time target acquisition, threat identification, and strike coordination.

5. *Modular payload configuration*: Its modular bays and hardpoints support *payload customization*, enabling mission-specific configurations for combat, reconnaissance, or communication relay operations.

Key specifications:

- *Type*: Medium-altitude long-endurance (MALE) armed UAV
- *Developer*: General Atomics Aeronautical Systems, United States
- *First flight*: 2001 (Operational: 2007)
- *Wingspan*: 20 m (66 ft)
- *Length*: 11 m (36 ft)
- *Maximum speed*: 480 km/h (300 mph)
- *Endurance*: 27 hours
- *Ceiling*: 50,000 ft (15,200 m)

- *Propulsion*: Honeywell TPE331-10 turboprop engine, 900 hp
- *Payload capacity*: 1700 kg (3800 lb)
- *Armament*: AGM-114 Hellfire missiles, GBU-12 Paveway II, GBU-38 JDAMs
- *Primary roles*: ISR, precision strike, surveillance, border, and maritime patrol

4.5.2.4 Heron TP (Eitan) (2004)

The Heron TP (Eitan), developed by Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI) in 2004, stands as one of the most capable and versatile medium-altitude long-endurance (MALE) UAVs of the third generation. As an evolution of the earlier Heron-1 system, the Heron TP was designed to perform strategic intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (ISR), target acquisition, and